

Vaibhav is from Delhi and Parag's ancestral family is from Gujarat. The couple now lives together in Arlington, Virginia, US

'WE'RE LEFT VULNERABLE'

Vaibhav and Parag got legally married in the US in 2017. While Vaibhav is an Indian citizen, Parag is an Overseas Citizen of India (OCI). Yet, the couple couldn't get their marriage registered in India. "An officer at the Indian consulate in New York admitted that it was because we were a gay couple," says Parag. This is despite the fact that the Foreign Marriage Act, 1969, requires India to recognise marriages that are legally solemnised abroad. "We have a two-month-old daughter. We're about to have a son.... Without the protection of the law, we are all vulnerable," says Parag. And that's why they moved the Delhi HC in 2020.

"When you love your country, it's called patriotism. When your country loves you, that's called justice. We look forward to getting a little more justice and a lot more love"

– PARAG VIJAY MEHTA

As a child, Vaibhav was bullied in school and even by a few relatives. Now, he wants to be part of the movement trying to help LGBTQIA+ people in India. "The government shouldn't work to exclude millions of its people from the very institutions we celebrate above all others: marriage and family," says Parag.

VIEWPOINT

KIREN RIJIJU

Union Law Minister, on the five-judge Constitution bench hearing petitions seeking legalisation of same-sex marriages



"If five wise men decide something that is correct according to them, I cannot make any adverse comment against them. But if people do not want it, you cannot impose things on them"

UNION GOVERNMENT'S AFFIDAVIT

in the Supreme Court

"The legislative understanding of marriage in the Indian statutory and personal law regime refers only to marriage between a biological man and a biological woman and any interference would cause complete havoc with the delicate balance of personal laws in the country and in accepted societal values"